Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFILE

Butcher and meat-counter professional with experience since 2015 in carcass breakdown, customer service and food hygiene. Skilled in cutting and portioning beef, pork and lamb, making fresh sausages, rotating stock using FIFO, and recording cold-chain temperature checks. Friendly and knowledgeable when advising customers on cuts and cooking methods.

EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante, Zagreb *2019–present*

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides each week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Prepare four kinds of fresh sausage to the shop's recipes, including ćevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez; produce about 40 kg per week in the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix following customer feedback; the ćevapi won second place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Rotate cold-room stock each morning using FIFO, keeping the oldest products at the front.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily.
- Serve around 120 customers on a Saturday and advise on cuts, quantities and cooking times.
- Trained two apprentices in safe knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepared whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting at weddings and family events, including a 180-guest wedding order in 2024.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial for beef ribs, recording temperature and weight loss; dry-aged rib is now sold by pre-order.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac Meat Hall Stall, Zagreb *2015–2019*

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at close.
- Created a closing and cleaning checklist after a hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb 2015

HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate 2021; renewed 2024

Preparing for the Master Butcher examination (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027; not yet passed

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) · Boning and trimming · Meat cutting and portioning · Fresh sausage making · FIFO stock rotation · HACCP food hygiene · Cold-chain temperature checks and records · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · Customer service and advice · Cash handling

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good, customer-facing) · German (basic)